



Momo the Loaf Cat

A cat folded into a perfect loaf — one no-sew piece on an oval base; ears crocheted onto the head and the tail worked off the body, so nothing is sewn on

Design Code NS 06

No-sew body

Advanced beginner

2-2.5 hours

Stitch counts verified

About 7.9 cm (3.1 in) long, 5.2 cm (2 in) wide and 4.3 cm (1.7 in) tall — a low, wide loaf, wider than it is tall (about 1.2 : 1)

Worsted #4 ~10 g • white + pink contrast scraps • 3.5 mm hook • two 8 mm safety eyes (or embroidered)

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SAFETY — READ THIS FIRST

Momo has two 8 mm safety eyes — small parts. Lock the washers firmly from the inside and pull-test each eye.

Embroidering the eyes is safer, but it does not make Momo a tested toy: not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71, so do not describe finished Momos as “baby-safe”. For a child under three, embroider and say “embroidered, no small parts”.

The ears and tail are worked into the body (stronger than sewing), but still weave every end in at least 5 cm and knot the embroidery floss inside.

Materials

- **Main yarn:** worsted #4, about 10 g. Grey, ginger, cream or black — all sell equally well. One 25 g ball makes two.
- **Contrast:** small amounts of white for the chest and paws, pink for the nose and inner ears.
- **Hook:** 3.5 mm (US E-4) — tight gauge so stuffing cannot show.
- **Eyes:** 2 x 8 mm safety eyes, or embroider in black.
- **Also needed:** polyfill about 10 g; tapestry needle; stitch marker; black embroidery floss.

Gauge & size check

About 4.5 mm per stitch and 4.3 mm per round.

Finished size about 7.9 cm long, 5.2 cm wide and 4.3 cm tall — a low, wide loaf. The 48-stitch oval base sets the whole size of the cat.

Abbreviations — US terms

MR magic ring • ch chain • sc single crochet • inc 2 sc in one st • dec invisible decrease • sl st slip stitch
• BLO back loop only • FO fasten off • (n) stitch count.

Construction at a glance

- **The oval base is THE step.** crochet into BOTH sides of a starting chain: across the front, corner increases into the last chain, then back along the opposite side and into the last loop. That turns a chain into a flat oval instead of a strip. Do NOT use a magic-ring circle here — a round base gives a sphere every time.
- **Base size sets the cat.** the base is worked up to 48 stitches before the walls begin. Stopping at 36 gives a body about 60 mm long and 40 mm across that comes out tall and round no matter how you stuff it.

The techniques that make this pattern

- **1. The magic ring** — used for the tail's first stitches. Wrap yarn around two fingers, pull up a loop and work the round into the ring, then pull the tail tight.
- **2. Work in a spiral** — no joins and no chain 1 between rounds; move the marker up each round — there is no join to count from.
- **3. Back loop only (BLO)** — work into the far loop only; the unused loops form a raised ridge — the visible edge where the oval base meets the walls. That ridge is what makes the loaf read as folded rather than moulded.
- **4. The invisible decrease** — front loops only of the next two stitches, yarn over and pull through both, then yarn over and pull through the remaining two. Every dec here is worked this way.
- **5. Flat rows (ch 1, turn)** — the ears are not worked in the round: chain 1, turn, and work back along the row. Each row is shorter than the one before, forming the ear point.
- **6. Working into body fabric** — the tail starts by pushing the hook through the finished body wall — go under a WHOLE stitch, not just one loop, or it will pull out.

1 · Base & body — oval base to a 6-stitch close

The BLO round at Rnd 7 leaves the ridge that reads as the folded loaf edge.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
Found.	ch 9	—	the oval foundation
1	sc in 2nd ch, sc in next 6, 3 sc in last ch, sc in next 6, 2 sc in last loop		
		18	around both sides of chain
2	inc, 6 sc, inc x3, 6 sc, inc x2	24	
3	sc, inc, 6 sc, [sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [sc, inc] x2	30	
4	2 sc, inc, 6 sc, [2 sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [2 sc, inc] x2		
		36	
5	3 sc, inc, 6 sc, [3 sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [3 sc, inc] x2		
		42	
6	4 sc, inc, 6 sc, [4 sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [4 sc, inc] x2		
		48	BASE AT FULL SIZE
7	BLO sc around	48	ridge = base edge
8	sc in each st around	48	eyes at R8–R9
9	sc in each st around	48	stuff firmly from here
10	[6 sc, dec] x 6	42	
11	[5 sc, dec] x 6	36	
12	[4 sc, dec] x 6	30	ears worked onto R12
13	[3 sc, dec] x 6	24	
14	[2 sc, dec] x 6	18	
15	[sc, dec] x 6	12	top up stuffing
16	dec x 6	6	close via front loops

Finish: thread the tail through the front loop of each of the 6 remaining stitches, pull tight, knot and bury.
Shape check: the base is an oval about 79 mm long and 52 mm across; the walls add ten rounds of height, so the finished loaf is about 43 mm tall — wider than it is tall.

2 · Ears — crocheted straight onto Rnd 12, about 6 stitches apart

Join the main yarn to the head at Rnd 12, leaving about 6 stitches between the two ears, and work each ear as three short rows: Row 1: sc in next 5, ch 1, turn (5). Row 2: dec, sc, dec, ch 1, turn (3). Row 3: dec, sc (2) — the ear tip. Fasten off with a short tail; pull it through the 2 tip stitches to close the point and bury inside the head. Each row consumes exactly what the row before produced (5 → 3 → 2). Embroider a small pink triangle on the front of each ear for lining.

3 · Tail — worked off the body

Join the main yarn to the back of the body at about Rnd 9 on the centre line. Insert the hook under a whole body stitch, pull up a loop, and work the first 4 sc into the body fabric in a tight square; then continue in a normal spiral off those 4 stitches: Rnds 1-8 are 4 sc in each round. Do NOT stuff — a thin tail curls around the loaf far better than a stuffed one. Fasten off and bury.

4 • Face & markings

- **Eyes:** fix the 8 mm eyes between Rnds 8 and 9, about 7 stitches apart, LOW and wide on the front (7 sts ~ 32 mm, roughly 60% of the body width). Low eyes read as a cat; high eyes read as a bear.
- **Nose:** a small pink triangle centred between and just below the eyes, with two short stitches angled down from the point for the mouth.
- **Whisker dots:** three tiny black French knots on each side of the nose.
- **Chest & paws:** with white yarn, embroider a soft oval on the chest and two small ovals at the front of the base for tucked paws — this is what turns a plain loaf into a cat.

Long, low and wide — the BLO ridge and tucked paws make the loaf read as a folded cat.

For your Etsy listing

- **Listing tip:** grey tabby, orange ginger, cream, black and calico (grey base with ginger and cream patches embroidered on afterwards) — listing all five as photos in one listing outperforms separate listings. Buyers choose a cat, not a pattern.

Colorways

 Grey tabby  Orange ginger  Cream  Black  Calico

Troubleshooting

- **It came out round.** you stopped increasing at Rnd 4 instead of Rnd 6, worked too many plain rounds at Rnds 8-9, or used a magic-ring base instead of the oval. The base must reach 48 stitches.
- **Tall and narrow.** the base did not reach 48. Count the stitches at Rnd 6 before the BLO round — that one number decides the whole shape.
- **Ears lean back.** join the yarn one round lower and angle the first row slightly forward.
- **Tail falls off.** the first 4 sc must go through the body fabric under a whole stitch, not just one loop.
- **Stuffing shows.** go down to a 3.0 mm hook — loose gauge on 3.5 mm is the usual cause.
- **Face looks like a bear.** eyes too high and too close. Drop them a round and widen to 7 stitches.

Why this pattern works — validation summary

Every stitch count in this pattern was checked with deterministic math (Crochet Pattern Checker): round-by-round production vs. consumption, stated counts, and every size claim against the stated gauge.

Check	Result
Oval ladder 18 → 24 → 30 → 36 → 42 → 48, stated counts match	✓ verified
Body Rnds 7-16: 48 → 6 with [n sc, dec] ladders consuming fully	✓ verified
Ear rows 5 → 3 → 2 consume exactly	✓ verified
Loaf 79 x 52 mm base ~ 216 mm perimeter = 48 sts x 4.5 mm	✓ verified
Height 10 wall rounds x 4.3 mm = 43 mm	✓ verified
Eye gap 7 sts = 31.5 mm ~ 60% of the 52 mm width	✓ verified
36-st alternative base ~ 60 x 40 mm (corrected from '34 mm across')	✓ verified

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SAFETY REMINDER

Not tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71) and uses 8 mm safety eyes. Finished items sold for children must be assessed against local toy-safety laws; for young children, embroider the eyes and secure every end.

Happy crocheting! Tag your makes with #NovalityStore and #MomoTheLoafCat — thank you for supporting an independent pattern designer.

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